

Teach For India

Founded: 2009

Sector: Education Equity, addressing learning gaps for children from low-income communities

TFlx sites across India



Teach For India started in the 1980s through Shaheen Mistri's early work with Akanksha Centres, providing after-school education to slum children in Mumbai. Formalized in 2009 after a McKinsey study and inspiration from Teach For America founder Wendy Kopp, it launched its first Fellowship cohort of 78 graduates in Mumbai and Pune to combat educational inequity.

Founded by Shaheen Mistri—who returned to India at 18 to tackle slum education gaps—Teach For India grew from her Akanksha Foundation model into a national movement.

It places top graduates as full-time teachers in low-income schools, building lifelong leaders for systemic change. By 2024 (its 15th year), it expanded to 8 cities amid COVID challenges, innovating with digital tools and community aid.

Service Categories:

Education Equity: Places Fellows in under-resourced schools for direct teaching; **Leadership Development:** Trains 1,000+ Fellows yearly with professional support; nurtures 5,500+ alumni for roles in schools, government, and startups.

TEACHFORINDIA

Teach For India's Impact



~1000

Fellows teach in classrooms across 8 cities

33500

Students directly impacted in our classrooms

~5500

Alumni continue to serve children at depth and scale

50M

Children reached by our Alumni movement

160+

Organisations founded by our Alumni

Core Programmes:

Teach For India operates through five key programmes that collectively strengthen teaching, leadership, innovation, and systemic reform within India's education ecosystem.

Firki is Teach For India's teacher education platform focused on strengthening classroom practice at scale. It supports teachers and school leaders through blended learning, mentorship, and reflective practice, enabling them to improve instructional quality, student engagement, and learning outcomes. Firki works with both government and low-cost private schools, emphasizing contextualized, practice-based professional development rather than one-size-fits-all training.

TFlx is an incubator for social entrepreneurs committed to

addressing educational inequity. It supports early-stage founders by providing seed funding, mentorship, leadership coaching, and access to a strong education-focused network. TFlx enables innovators to design scalable solutions across areas such as ed-tech, teacher development, school leadership, and student learning, contributing to long-term systemic change beyond classrooms.

The Kids Education Revolution (KER) is a student-centered movement that places children's voices at the heart of educational reform. It focuses on holistic student development—academic, emotional, and aspirational—by empowering students to articulate their needs, lead change within their schools, and envision meaningful futures. KER emphasizes that children

are not passive recipients of education, but active agents in shaping it.

InnovatED works to catalyze innovation within schools and education systems. The programme collaborates with educators, school leaders, and organizations to design, test, and scale innovative practices that improve learning environments. By fostering experimentation and evidence-based solutions, InnovatED bridges the gap between grassroots innovation and system-wide adoption.

The Government Relations programme focuses on influencing education policy and strengthening public education systems. Teach For India partners with state and local governments to support teacher capacity building, and leadership development